

CALM CARE CHECKLIST

Beginner grooming & handling • use with species-specific veterinary guidance

1 BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ Confirm the animal is healthy enough for grooming
- ☐ Choose a quiet, non-slip, well-lit area
- ☐ Prepare towel, soft brush, treats, and approved products
- ☐ Keep the session short; plan an easy exit

2 SAFE CONTACT

- ☐ Approach slowly and let the animal see your hands
- ☐ Support the torso and joints—never pull or suspend by limbs
- ☐ Try one gentle stroke, then pause and observe
- ☐ Avoid eyes, ears, wounds, irritated skin, and painful areas

3 READ THE RESPONSE

- ☐ CONTINUE: loose posture, calm breath, soft face, voluntary return
- ☐ PAUSE: turning away, tension, repeated repositioning
- ☐ STOP: freezing, struggling, vocalizing, rapid breathing, biting
- ☐ For non-domestic animals: trained caregivers only

4 FINISH & FOLLOW UP

- ☐ End before fatigue; reward calm cooperation
- ☐ Clean and dry tools; wash hands
- ☐ Note coat, skin, nail, ear, or behavior changes
- ☐ Contact a veterinarian for pain, wounds, parasites, or sudden changes

WHEN IN DOUBT: STOP • SUPPORT • SEEK EXPERT HELP